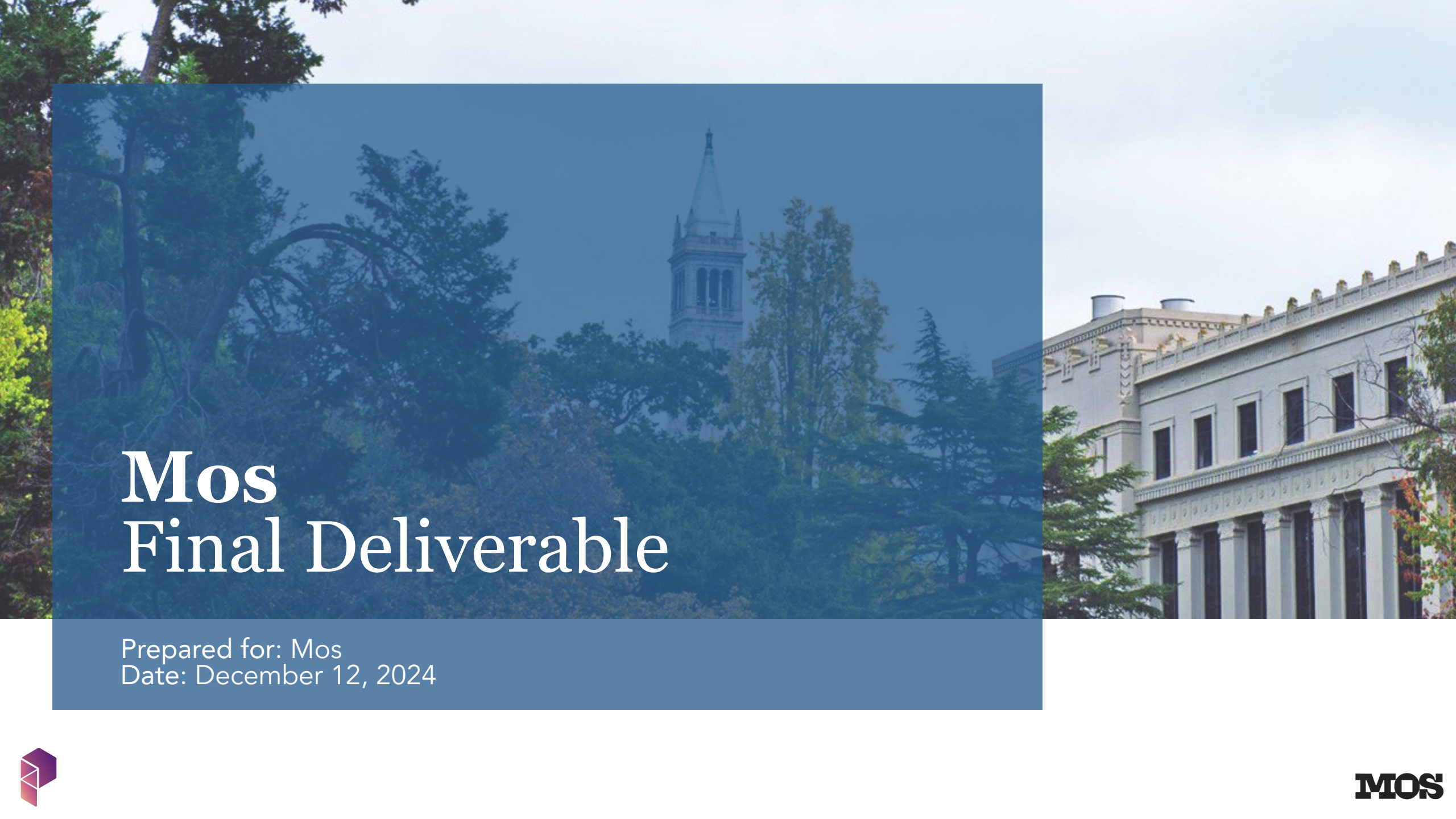


The background of the slide is a photograph of a university campus. On the left, there are dense green trees. In the center, a tall, white, Gothic-style bell tower with a pointed roof rises above the foliage. On the right, a large, light-colored classical building with a row of columns and a decorative cornice is visible. A semi-transparent blue rectangle is overlaid on the left side of the image, containing the title and subtitle text.

Mos Final Deliverable

Prepared for: Mos
Date: December 12, 2024



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Midpoint Recap

Interview Insights

Case Studies

Feature Mockups

Strategy Implementation

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Leadership Team



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Midpoint Recap

For the first half of the project, our associates conducted in-depth survey research and data analysis, ideating potential features for Mos



Competitor Analysis

- Evaluated top competitors and indirect competitors to pinpoint areas of opportunity and potential niche user offerings that Mos can explore
- Leveraged insights from competitive analyses to understand where Mos should focus their development efforts
- Utilized secondary research to build general understanding of user group and audience needs



User Personas

- Determined primary user personas in penetrated groups as well as potential areas of expansion to better develop potential solutions
- Assessed customer needs based on user persona, pinpointing specific strategies Mos can leverage to increase acquisition
- Expanded on defined customers profiles, focusing on user engagement and acquisition



Survey Analysis

- Conducted in-depth user research through survey outreach to university and high school populations, determining key insights for feature ideation
- Explored potential for interest in collaborative features such as forums and community groups based off survey responses
- Drafted potential feature ideas with survey insights and secondary research



Data Insights Summary

Survey data from MOS's intended audience suggests several improvements and features for user experience and acquisition

Key Insights

Around half of MOS users are high school students or younger, incentivizing users to start applying earlier. There is also a potential for collaboration and sharing information amongst users applying to scholarships

Community

Community Forums

- Scholarship-Specific forums
- Community of similar interests
- User Reviews

Anonymized Profiles

- Toggles for profile visibility
- Reduces feelings of judgement, encouraging participation
- Overview of joined forums

Personalization

Family Accounts

- Shared Accountability amongst parents or siblings
- Word of Mouth Acquisition
- Administrative Tasks

Personalized Dashboards

- Progress Tracker for applications
- Analytics and Statistics of activity
- Point and Goal Thresholds

Acquisition

Referral Rewards Program

- Attracts new users while reinforcing engagement (User Ambassadors)
- Both users are rewarded
- Credible Advertising

School-Specific Campaigns

- Encourages group participation
- Simplifies outreach process
- Online and in-person campaigns



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User Insights Summary

The most common complaints, necessities, and patterns with the current financial aid experience for college students and applicants

Credibility

- As a platform that organizes the distribution of scholarships/grants/loans, how can MOS be a trusted, credible source of aid?
- To signup, users would need to upload personal and financial details which can cause security concerns

Scholarship Forum

- Suggested independently by an interviewee
- A college-specific forum with public, collaborative insights about relevant scholarships
- Interviewees leaned toward forced public usernames to increase credibility and humanize the platform

Locating Scholarships

- Finding applicable scholarships to your major, interest, and background is difficult as backed by the interviewees
- Necessity for an easy database of niche loans and grants that are more specific than merit-based grants

Key Takeaways

- Users report a need for a credible community forum to collaborate and share insights on scholarship details. Locating niche scholarships that are applicable based on a user's background, major, and interest is too difficult.
- Users also expressed a desire for when uploading personal and financial information, highlighting the importance of trust in the platform.



Navigating Complexity: What Students Need for Scholarship Success

Navigating Overwhelming Scholarship Process with a Need for Personalization & Community Support

Adrianna Ron

Year: Sophomore
Major: Applied Mathematics
Familiarity with Scholarships:
Moderately familiar, but
overwhelmed by volume

Insights



- Seeks to collaborate with other individuals to stay motivated when applying for scholarships
- Overwhelmed by email newsletters & unfiltered volume
- Unable to decide what scholarships are best suited for her

Pain points



- Time-consuming to filter scholarships she qualifies for
- No way to reuse information across applications
- Overwhelmed by volume and difficulty in knowing what's legitimate
- Difficulty in filtering relevant scholarships

Benefits



- Prefers anonymous platforms for judgment-free exploration
- Values shared community tips from sorority and ASUC peers
- Desires features like scholarship progress trackers, deadline notifications, and relevant recommendations

Key Insights

I never know which scholarships are legitimate—I wish I could see other people applying or get more background information about them. I am open to collaborating on scholarship and receiving help from others, but I want the option to appear as anonymous.



Student-Scholarship Relationships Through Community Support

Complete user interview conducted on a freshman who discusses her community journey through the scholarship process in Tahoe, California.

Chloe Tippet

Year: Freshman

Major: Marine Science

Familiarity with Scholarships: Yes, very familiar with the process

Insights



- Aware of community-based scholarships like Tahoe Programs and strongly supports them
- Was given school-provided resources that were instrumental in her process

Pain points



- Believes FAFSA was poorly run and was open far too long in the year
- Limited personal organization, primarily uses a spreadsheet for finances.
- Open to features that simplify tracking and collaboration.

Benefits



- Wants a desktop website with transparent, easy to navigate information
- Values community involvement in scholarship exploration through meaningful discourse
- Catered to student-scholarship relationships, not just foundational processes.

Key Insights

- Chloe struggles with FAFSA due to international challenges but values community-driven resources, peer recommendations, and clear scholarship descriptions to simplify the financial aid process.
- She prefers a desktop-based platform with tools for organization, peer collaboration, and a focus on the student-scholarship relationship.



Scholarship 101: What Beginners Need Most

Understanding the application process through the eyes of a beginner

Carys Truong



Year: Sophomore
Major: Biology
Familiarity with Scholarships: Not very familiar

Violet Tran



Year: Sophomore
Major: Nursing
Familiarity with Scholarships: Not at all familiar

Pain points

- Feels as if you must take on a lot of grunt work, which is difficult when you are unmotivated
- Very overwhelming when considering what each application asks for
- Difficulty in identifying what to write about in scholarship essays
- Struggles writing it in a way that will grab attention

Benefits

- Sharing information with family or trusted individuals make the process easier
- Peer reviews and success stories greatly increase confidence and reliability
- Most helpful scholarship dashboard features:
Community elements, sharing information with family, and deadlines

Insights

- Not well-versed in financial aid resources
- Wants more help with brainstorming and gathering ideas for essay prompts
- Prefers anonymous accounts especially when sharing financial information



Scholarship 101: What Beginners Need Most

Understanding the application process through the eyes of a beginner

Nicolette Pin



Year: Sophomore
Major: Biology
Familiarity with Scholarships: Familiar, used to apply but not currently on any

Natalie Tran



Year: Sophomore
Major: Nursing
Familiarity with Scholarships: Familiar, used to apply but not currently on any.

Pain points

- Process feels a little pointless and scary
- Lack of strong support system other than parents because there is a lot of stigma
- Struggles to navigate the overwhelming number of platforms and opportunities
- Frustrated by competition and the need to create new accounts for applications (e.g., platforms like Workday).

Benefits

- More comfortable with anonymous accounts when sharing any personal information
- Success stories and peer testimonials increase trust in a platform
- Financial aid navigation is seen as an individual journey, with counselors occasionally assisting.
- Most helpful scholarship dashboard features: Requirements, Personal financial information, Deadlines.

Insights

- Scholarship deadlines are manageable despite schoolwork
- Reputable sources are go-to platforms making it imperative that it is trusted
- No one-stop shop currently for all financial aid resources and organization
- Navigates college finances by taking loans, directly allocating funds to tuition and rent



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Case Studies: Community Forums

A competitor analysis of Duolingo and Ed Discussion Forum platforms to better understand community collaboration

The screenshot shows the 'New Question' form in the Ed Discussion Forum. At the top, there's a 'Cancel' button and a 'New Question' title. Below this, there are two tabs: 'Question' (active) and 'Post'. The 'Question' tab has a 'Title' input field and a 'Similar Threads' section. The 'Post' tab has a 'Post' button. Below the tabs, there's a 'Category' section with several tags: 'General and logistics', 'Midterm exams', 'Final exam', 'Reading responses', 'Course pack topics', 'Essay planning', 'Practice essay', and 'Presentation'. A warning icon and text 'Select a category.' are also present. Below the category section, there's a checkbox for 'Anonymous' with the text 'Hide your name from students'. The bottom section shows a list of questions with user avatars, names, flags, and timestamps. The first question is by 'alli_gracieee' (Spanish flag) asking 'How does it matter if i say good morning or good night. How is either one wrong?' with 215 upvotes and 7 years ago. The second question is by 'LBoksha' (Norwegian flag) asking 'I thought the same thing, but after a little research, it turns out that noches is feminine, while días is masculine. Therefore, "Buenos noches" is grammatically incorrect; for noches you'd use buenas instead of buenos.' with 639 upvotes and 7 years ago. The third question is by 'elsouthridge' (Spanish flag) asking 'Thanks. I checked on translate and both worked. Good to know!' with 80 upvotes and 7 years ago. The fourth question is by 'kranthi10' (Spanish flag) asking 'Thank you soo much' with 7 upvotes.

Ed Discussion Forum

- Class Forums: Community spaces organized by course.
- Q&A Support: Students ask questions, TAs provide answers.
- 24/7 Access: users receive support on their schedules, making it ideal for flexible learning
- TA Engagement: Active TA involvement supports adds an extra layer of reliability and academic rigor

Duolingo

- Users can discuss answers in discussion board to help other users gain better understanding of language
- Users can see profiles of other users, motivating them to continue learning and meet their streaks
- Seeks to enhance engagement and drives continuous learning

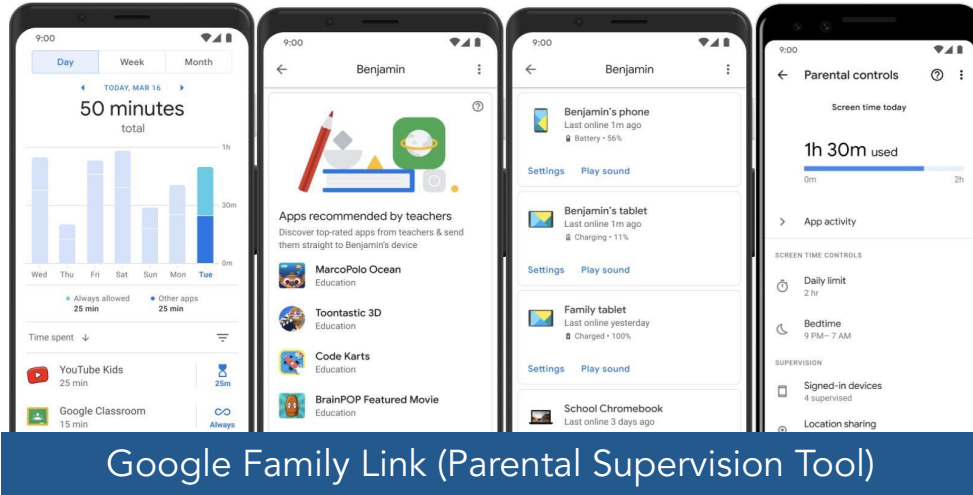
Key Insights

Users benefit from community forums that are segmented and specialized based on their class or learning preference.



Case Studies: Family Accounts and Personalized Dashboards

College Board and Mint shows how family access features boost user retention and engagement, a potential feature for MOS



Google Family Link (Parental Supervision Tool)

Parental Oversight: Monitor and approve tasks or actions initiated by their children

Customized Roles: Children maintain independence in initiating actions, but parents are informed and can step in

Activity Tracking: Offers summaries of progress (e.g., apps used or time spent on devices)

Impact:

- Stronger parental engagement without overly restricting
- Increased trust and collaboration between parents and child



Intuit's Mint Family Budgeting Feature

Shared Dashboard: View and manage all expenses, savings, and income in one place

Goal Tracking: Collaboratively set financial goals (e.g., saving for college) and track progress

Notifications & Alerts: Remind upcoming bills, budgeting milestones, or irregular spending patterns

Impact:

- Increased user engagement due to collaborative goal-setting and shared responsibility.
- Enhanced transparency, between family members



Case Studies: Family Accounts and Personalized Dashboards

Case studies from several companies have shown the potential upsides of implementing personalized dashboards

Duolingo

- Personalized dashboard: Shows daily goals, streak count, and current courses.
- Engagement: Users spend an average of 10 minutes per day on the app.
- Implemented a Growth Model that breaks down topline metrics like Daily Active Users (DAU) into smaller user segments.

Fitbit

- Personalized dashboard: Shows daily calorie goal, food intake, and exercise.
- Results: 20% increase in daily active users (DAU) within six months, and 40% increase in average session duration in the Fitbit app.
- Engagement: Users who log food for 7 days are 88% more likely to lose weight.

Headspace

- Personalized dashboard: Shows recommended meditations and mindfulness exercises.
- Engagement Strategies: Provides options for session length and allows users to replay favorites.
- Results: Over 70 million downloads, 2 million paid subscribers, 26% uplift in new user activation.

Key Insights

These features not only keep users motivated by setting clear goals and providing rewards but also personalize the experience to individual needs, increasing the perceived value of each app. This strategy has proven to create a habit-forming loop, where users return daily, driven by both intrinsic motivation and extrinsic rewards.



Case Studies: Referral Programs

Well-crafted referral programs from major companies showed that such strategies can be essential to unlocking engagement for Mos.



Dropbox's Referral Program

Overview:

- Dropbox offered an **additional 500MB of storage to both the referrer and the referred friend for every successful referral**, up to a certain limit.

Strategy:

- This “dual reward” system incentivized users to refer multiple friends, **creating exponential growth**.

Results:

- **3900% Growth in 15 Months:** Dropbox's referral program became a landmark success, resulting in a massive increase in sign-ups within a short period.
- Users brought in other users, creating a community effect where **more people wanted to join because of the program's social proof and reward**.



PayPal's Referral Incentive Strategy

Overview:

- PayPal offered a **direct cash incentive—\$10 to both the referrer and the referred friend upon account sign-up and use of the service**.

Strategy:

- The cash reward was **compelling and motivated users to try the service**, which otherwise might have been perceived as unfamiliar or risky.

Results:

- Helped PayPal achieved over **100,000 users in its early days, a foundational leap for the platform**.
- PayPal **established trust among new users through peer recommendations**, crucial in a market unfamiliar with online transactions.

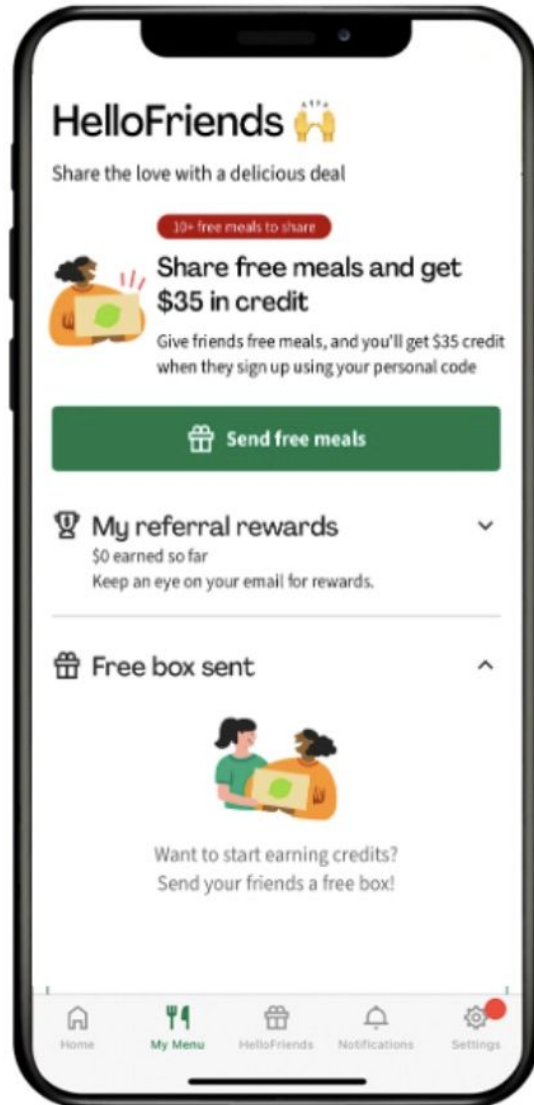
Key Takeaways

Both Dropbox and PayPal's referral programs were pivotal to their user growth stories, showing how referral incentives can effectively increase user acquisition, a strategy which can be replicated by Mos.



Case Studies: Referral Programs

HelloFresh's referral program succeeds through dual incentives, time sensitive offers, and tiered rewards that drive engagement.



Overview

- Dual incentive structure: Offers a win-win scenario where referrers can choose to send a free meal box to a friend or offer \$40 off their first order while receiving \$20
- Time-sensitive offers: The referral program includes limited-time promotions, such as the "free box" option, creating a sense of urgency that prompts quicker participation
- Tiered rewards system: Long-term HelloFresh members can accumulate "Freebies" over time, allowing them to send a free week of meals to friends

Takeaways for MOS

- Implement a tiered reward system: Offer escalating benefits for users who consistently refer new customers, encouraging long-term engagement
- Create unique, high-value incentives: Exclusive rewards that align with MOS's core offering, such as limited-time access to premium features or personalized services.
- Leverage time-sensitive promotions: Introduce limited-time referral bonuses or special offers to create a sense of urgency and drive immediate action from users.

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Mockup Walkthrough: Community Forums

Highlighting features and UI of a community forum dashboard and comment section feature to encourage collaboration

Forum Organization

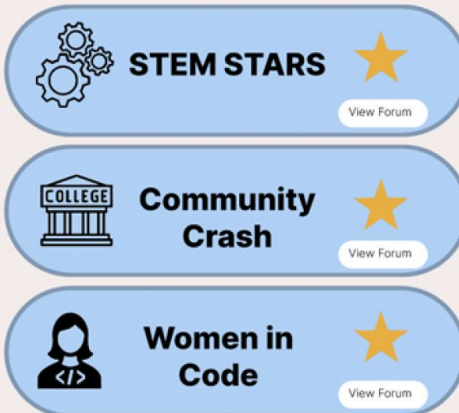
- Users browse communities based on their preferences, favorite forums, & have organized dashboard to see relevant communities.
- Centralized hub for all activity, simplifying users' experience.

Overview

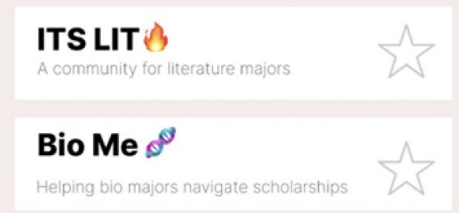
The community forum gives users the ability to customize their scholarship preferences & create a simplified dashboard. The ability to interact with others in similar communities gives targeted support & guidance.

Scholarship Community

Favorited Forums



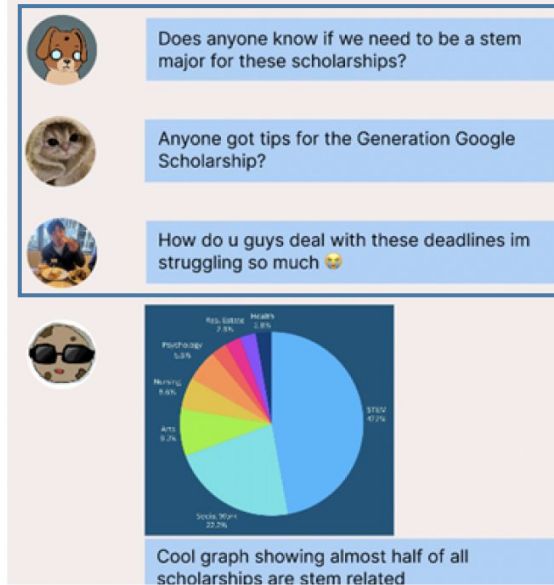
Recently Browsed



STEM STARS

A supportive community for students, professionals, and enthusiasts passionate about Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics! Dive into discussions about STEM-based scholarships, share tips for applications, discover funding opportunities, and connect with others navigating the path to academic and professional success.

Comment Section



Forum Overview

Provides a description of community to give students an idea of what kind of guidance they can find on the forum.

Comment Section

Users can make comments, post insights, and engage as collaborators within the forum foster dynamic discussions and data-driven decision-making

Mockup Walkthrough: Community Forums

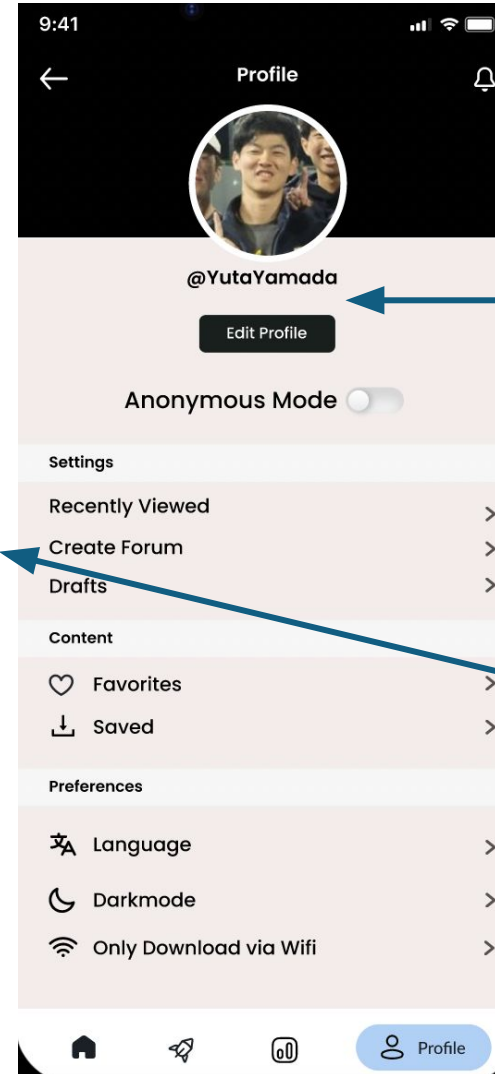
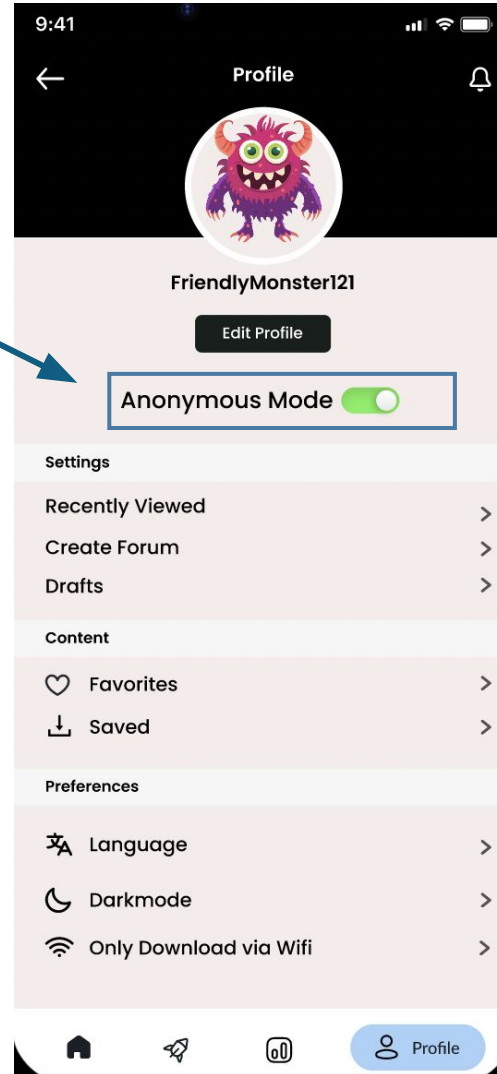
Highlighting features and UI of an anonymous and main profile account, making users comfortable with sharing scholarship info

Profile Switching

Users have the option to appear in forums as anonymous, similar to Reddit community threads creating a safe and judgment-free space for asking sensitive questions.

Overview

The profile toggle allows users to feel comfortable posting questions about scholarships, but also give them the ability to switch back to their main profile to view more personal financial information



Main Profile

The main profile view provides a complete overview of the user's activity, including forums they've joined, drafts saved, and preferences customized.

Create Forum

Users can create forums from their profile, posting as either anonymous or from their main profile fostering a collaborative space catering to levels of comfort and privacy.

Mockup Walkthrough: Family Accounts & Personal Dashboards

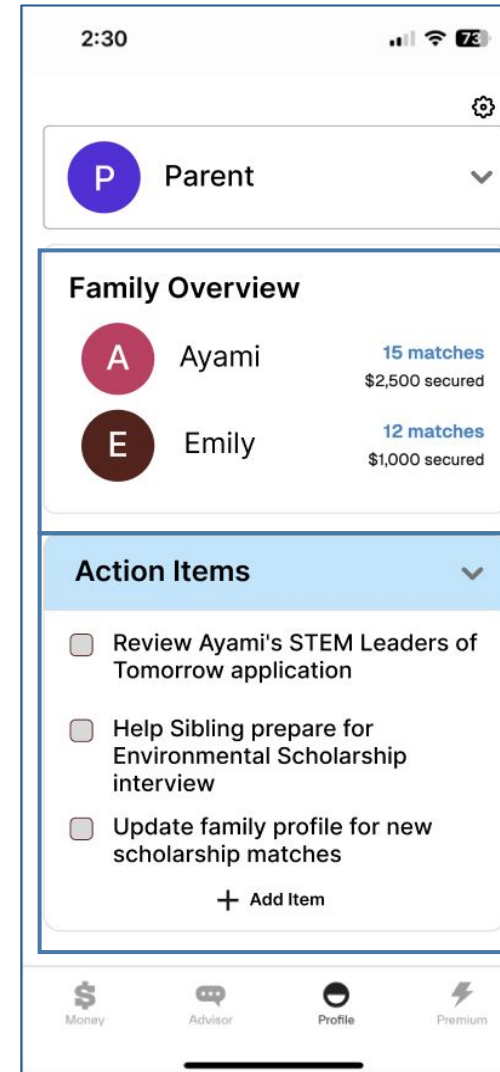
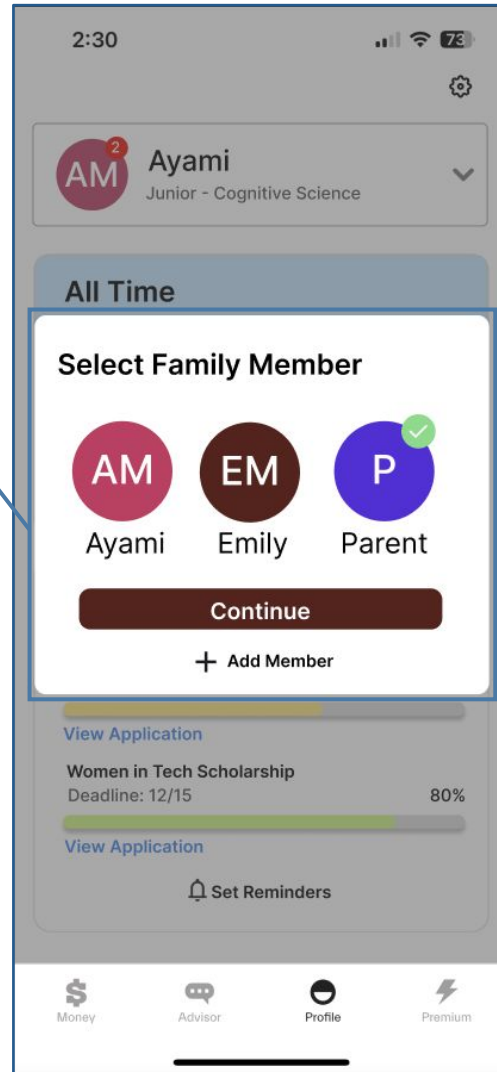
Highlighting features and UI of a "Family Account" and "Personalized Dashboard", encouraging more support and engagement for users.

Profile Switching

The interface allows easy switching between profiles and adding new family members with minimal effort.

Overview

The "Family Account" user interface helps students stay engaged by enabling parents progress monitoring and support channels. Features like action items ensure that students stay focused on their responsibilities.



Family Overview

Provides a consolidated view of all family members' progress, including the number of scholarship matches and amounts secured.

Action Items

The actionable task list makes it easy for users to track tasks and maintain focus.

This encourages engagement since parents can support students on tasks



Mockup Walkthrough: Family Accounts & Personal Dashboards

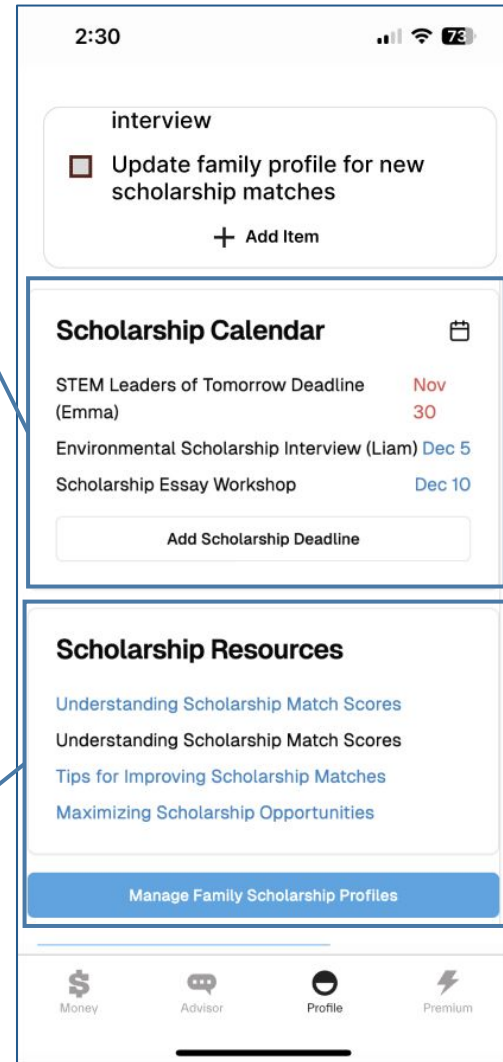
Highlighting features and UI of a “Family Account” and ”Personalized Dashboard”, encouraging more support and engagement for users.

Scholarship Calendar

A shared calendar helps families stay organized by centralizing all important deadlines and events, promoting collaboration and accountability among users

Scholarship Resources

The list of linked resources empowers parents with knowledge to optimize their kid’s scholarship applications, keep users engaged, and improve their success rates.

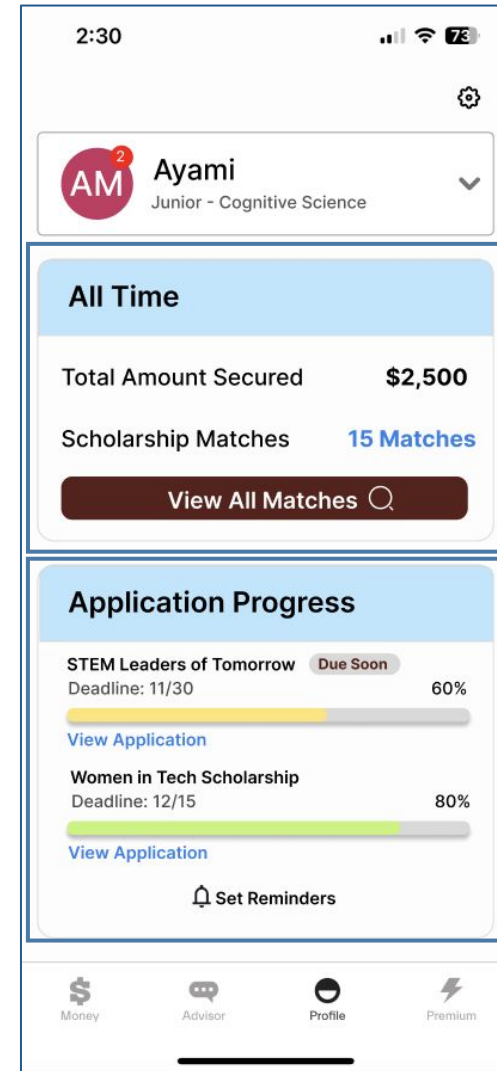


Overview of Personal Overview

The overview allows students to have a clear view of how much progress they’ve made, as well as encourage them explore new scholarship matches.

Application Progress

The application progress UI visualizes the progress of students, encouraging them to continue with their applications, as well as set reminders to themselves.



Mockup Walkthrough: Referral Programs

A streamlined referral program design can effectively boost engagement with clear visuals, concise instructions, and navigation

Brand Identity

Creates instant brand recognition and reinforces brand presence while maintaining readability of foreground elements.



Reward Visualization

The Green circular icon with "\$15" instantly conveys value, while "Both Gain" shows mutual benefit, moving participation



Progressive Disclosure

The numbered green circles with concise text break down the process into digestible steps without overwhelming users

- 1 Share your Mos referral link to help friends find scholarships faster
- 2 Your friend joins Mos Premium and unlocks exclusive tools.
- 3 Get a discount on Mos Premium as a reward—refer unlimited friends!

Persistent Navigation

The bottom maintains consistent access to core features while keeping the main referral interface clean and focused.

Code Presentation

Uses high contrast and clear segmentation, making it instantly copyable. The spacing and formatting reduce the chance of transcription errors.

Your Code
567 - 987779 - 98

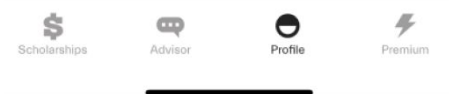
Share this code with your friends and enjoy the perks together! You and your friend will each receive \$15 toward Premium.

How It Works

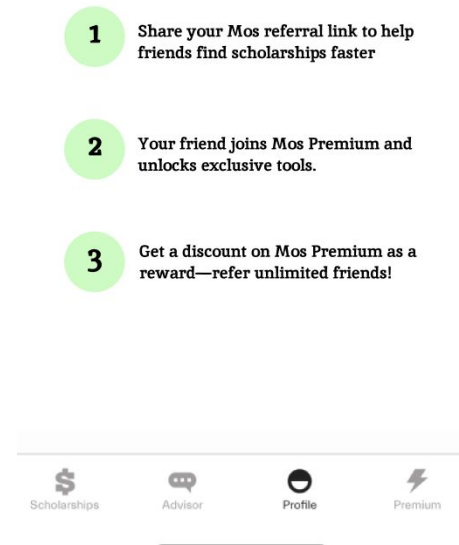


Strategic Social Integration

The Toolbar focuses on platforms where the target demographic (students) are most active, particularly TikTok and Instagram, alongside traditional channels.



Both Gain \$15



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GTM Strategy: Community Forums

Creating communities for students with similar backgrounds to discuss, review, and pose questions about scholarships



Main Group: High School Students applying to college and scholarships

Sub-Group:

- Engineering student wanting support from other engineers
- Previous Scholarship recipients sharing tips

Feature Differentiator

MOS's Community Forum feature allows for anyone knowledgeable about scholarships to be in direct 1:1 contact as well as 1:many contact with those who are looking for support on how to get the most out of their education financial aid

Promotional Tactic

- Offer 1-week free trials of premium features for users posting a threshold of forum questions
- Authorized knowledgeable users can be compensated for providing answers and insight on forums
- Provide testimonials and examples of how the platform has helped users succeed

Moderation

- **Community Guidelines and Reporting:** Establish clear rules for respectful and relevant content, allowing users to report violations for quick resolution
- **Incentives for Moderation:** Reward active moderators and trusted contributors with badges, discounts, or recognition to maintain engagement and quality

Key Metrics

User Engagement: Monthly active users
Return Rate: Percentage of users with multiple posts
Activity: New posts per day and Average replies per post



GTM Strategy: Community Forums

Full 9-Month Timeline for the Development, Launch, and Post Launch Optimization of Mos' Community Forum Feature

Overview

1. Developing Phase (August - November)

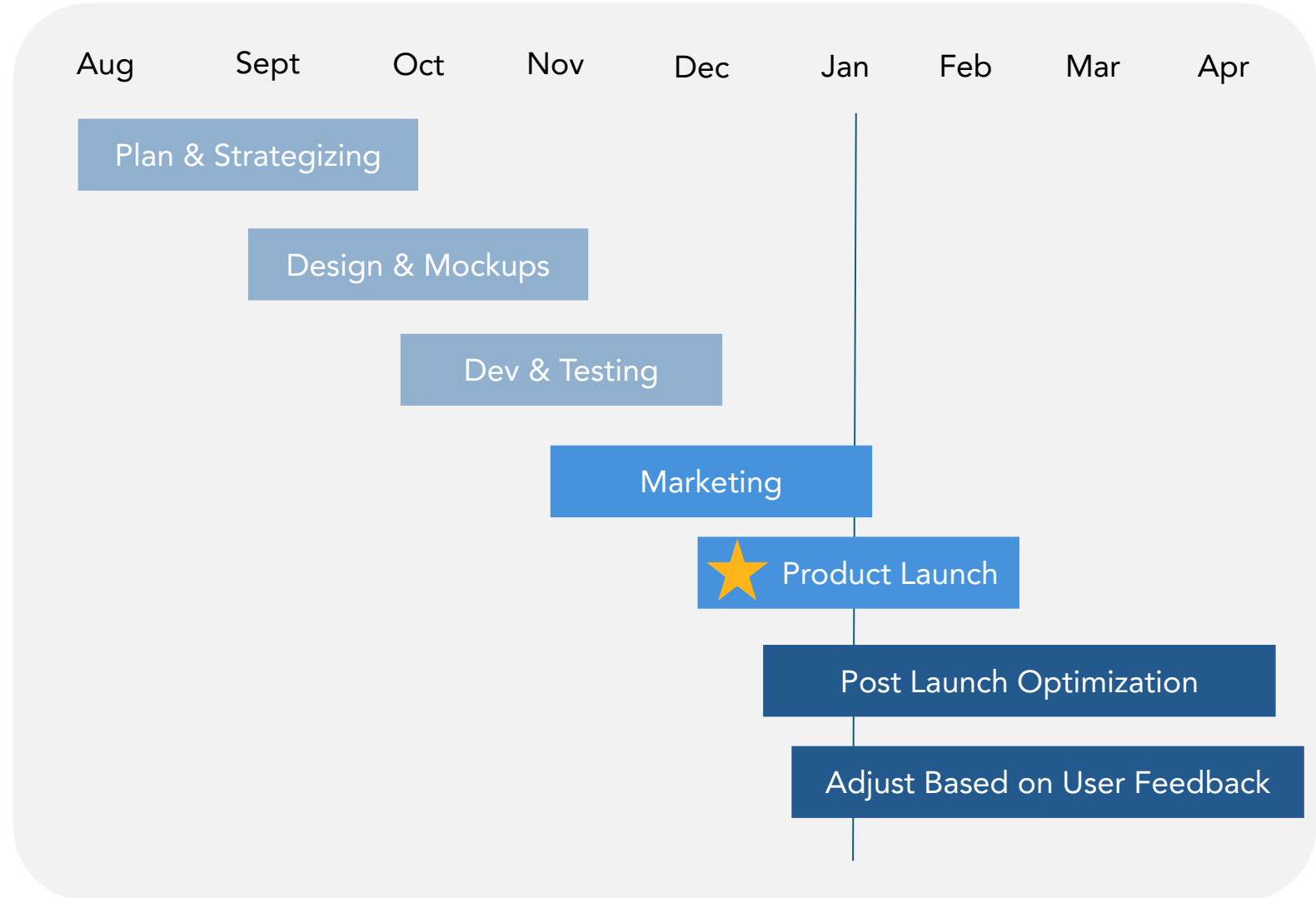
- Define objectives, target audience, and core features for the Mos community forum. Outline a roadmap and milestones.
- Create wireframes and mockups emphasizing usability and inclusivity. Gather feedback to build and develop design for forum.

2. Launching Phase (November - February)

- Promote the forum via social media. Use pre-launch activities to generate excitement.
- Launch with full functionality, onboarding tutorials, and responsive support for early users.

3. Post-Launch Phase (January - April)

- Monitor metrics (# of users), address issues, and roll out updates to enhance the user experience.
- Implement new features and improvements based on user input, fostering engagement and community growth.



GTM Strategy: Family Accounts and Personal Dashboards

Empowering families to navigate scholarships together through a seamless path to success within premium features



Main Group: High school and college students applying for scholarships

Sub-Group:

- Parents involved in their child's education and want more transparency
- Families juggling multiple scholarship deadlines and looking for organizational tools

Feature Differentiator

MOS's Family Account offers collaborative features, allowing both parents and students to manage tasks, deadlines, and financial details seamlessly in one platform
Task delegation tools and shared dashboards enhance usability while reducing stress

Promotional Tactic

Offer 1-month free trials of premium features for new family account users
Referral Discounts: Incentivize existing users to invite their families
Interactive live demos during webinars or school counseling events or PTA to showcase the feature

Social Media Marketing



Duolingo Case Study: Uses Tiktok with viral, relatable, and humorous videos featuring their mascot and trending content. Gained 2M+ followers and increased downloads, highlights the potential for MOS to drive awareness and trial signups

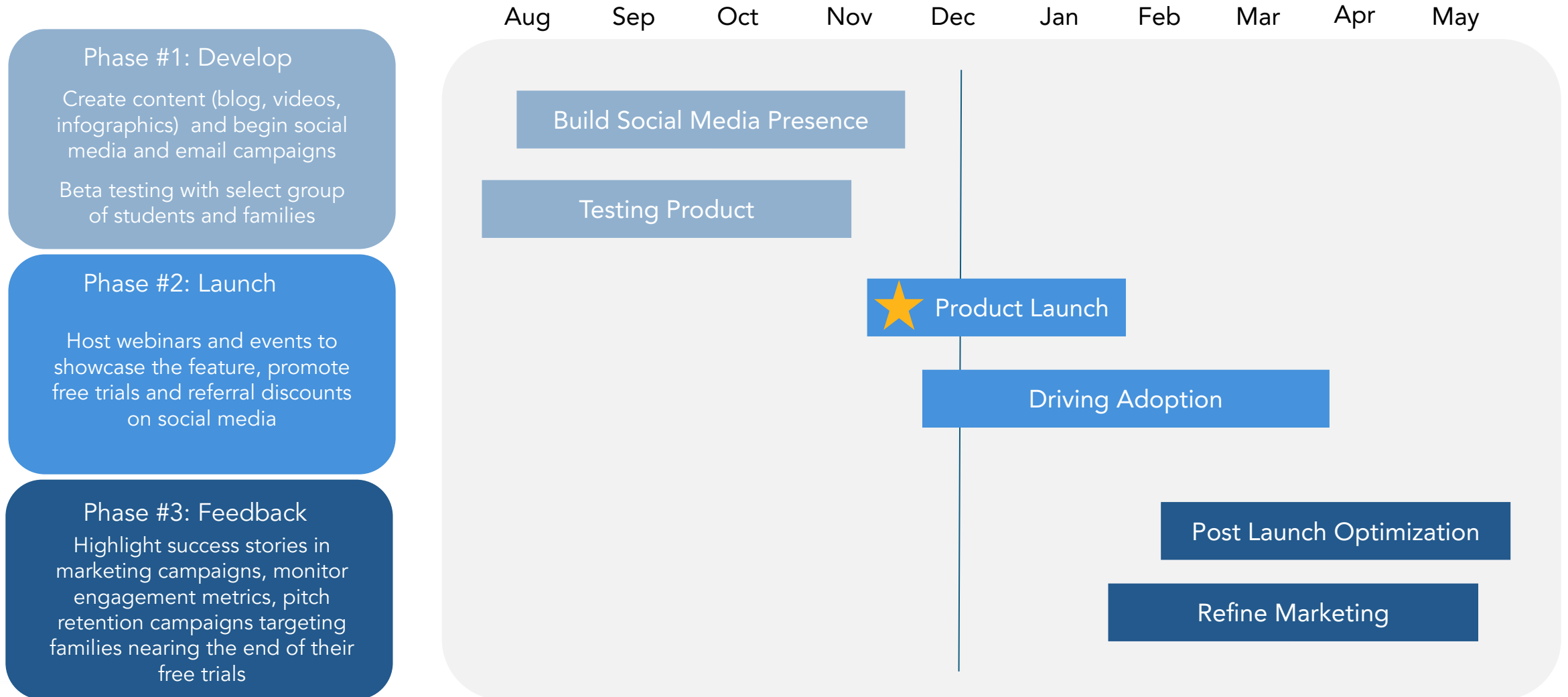
Key Metrics

Activation/Conversion Rate: Percentage of families that sign up for Premium
Engagement: Frequency of dashboard usage by parents and students
Task Completion Metrics: Average percentage of tasks completed collaboratively



GTM Strategy: Family Accounts and Personal Dashboards

10-Month Timeline for the Launch of the Family Account Feature



GTM Strategy: Referral Programs

Expanding user base through a program that allows people to encourage others to join.



Main Group: High school and college students applying for scholarships

Sub-Group:

- Peers and fellow students overwhelmed with the financial aid and scholarship process
- Parent groups that are heavily involved in children's education

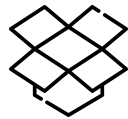
Feature Differentiator

- Many financial platforms rely on traditional advertising, but Mos can stand out with a peer-driven growth strategy that leverages the social nature of students.
- Referrals increase brand visibility and credibility as students introduce Mos to their friends, who are more likely to trust and engage with a service recommended by their peers.

Promotional Tactic

- Offer 3-day free trial of premium features for both referrer and referred, creating a win-win situation.
- Referral Reward Tiers: Pyramid based structure to induce more referrals from each existing member.
- 1-5 referrals, 5-10, and 10+ get different qualities of rewards trending upwards which encourages users to continue referring.

Social Media Marketing



- Dropbox: Utilized referral program which offered both parties incentives which allowed for exponential growth.
- Led to 3900% growth in 15 months

Key Metrics

- Referral Rate: % of existing users who refer new users
- Engagement: Frequency of referrals by individual user
- Net Promotor Score: Identify customer satisfaction through qualitative data



GTM Strategy: Referral Programs

10-Month Timeline for the Launch of the Referral Program

Develop

Define program goals, design rewards system, finalize referral mechanism and program

Build and configure referral program for desktop and mobile
Test end-to-end functionality to a small subset of existing users
Create promotional materials (email and social media campaigns)

Launch

Implement marketing on social media (TikTok, Instagram) and email campaigns to existing users

Post Launch

Monitor user engagement metrics (referral rate, engagement frequency, and net promotor score)

Analyze data to evaluate how to improve program and user experience

